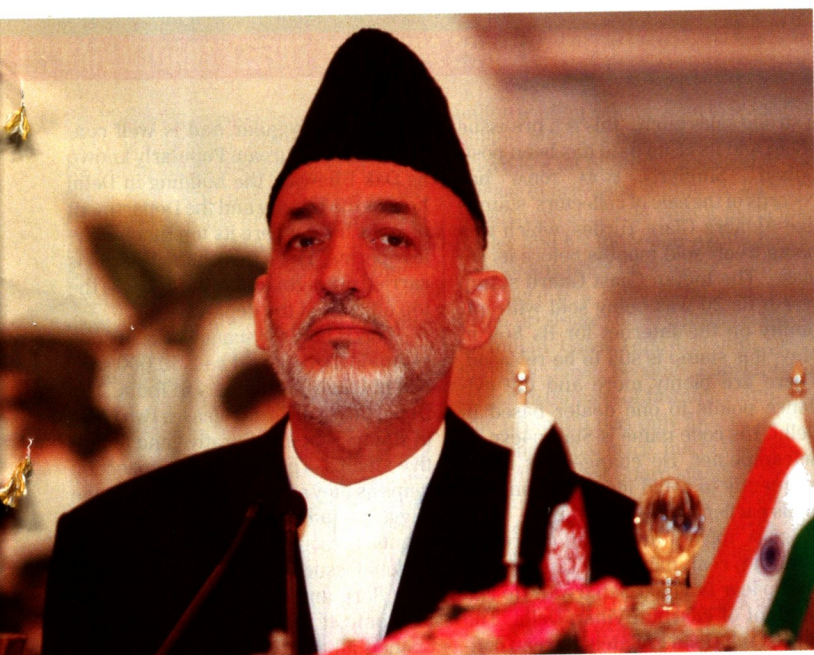




about the attack on the Indian mission in Kabul and the ceasefire violations, he said: "We will look into these, I am meeting Afghan President Hamid Karzai and I will ask him for more details and then we will investigate it."

Earlier too, like the Indian bowlers who managed to wreck the Sri Lankan batting attack in the Galle Test match that coincided with the summit, veteran Indian Foreign Minister Pranab Mukherjee bowled a googly to his Pakistani counterpart. "We expected a civilian government to be better, but we have been disappointed. The attack on the Indian Embassy was an attack on the mission of a sovereign country. Even in a state of war, missions are not attacked," Mukherjee told Pakistani Foreign Minister Shah Mahmood Qureshi. Sources said Mukherjee even told Qureshi that India had the "capacity to retaliate", as he read the riot act to his Pakistani counterpart.

Later Mukherjee confirmed that all was not well. "We did some tough talking; we told them this cannot be tolerated," he told INDIA TODAY. In fact, the signals coming out of Colombo indicate that the dialogue process, which was revived recently, may run into trouble. To act tough, India ignored a Pakistani request for a joint statement after the meeting, pointing to a chill in relations.

Terrorism dominated the SAARC Summit agenda. It was apparent that the suicide attack on the Indian Embassy has altered geopolitical equations, and with the role of the ISI coming under severe criticism from the US as well, it would need a concerted effort by all affected nations to rein in Pakistan-sponsored terrorism. The message was articulated by Karzai who reached Delhi from Colombo to meet Manmohan. India will join ranks with Afghanistan and the US to tackle the growing threat of terrorism and radicalism emanating from Pakistan. In the coming days, there will be closer cooperation between India and Afghanistan on security matters. India is also expected to work on a strategy to counter threats from Pakistan-sponsored terrorism. While the country will continue to engage with Pakistan diplomatically, it will also blend in a tougher approach, along with its allies, to tackle terror groups that endanger regional and global peace and security. ■